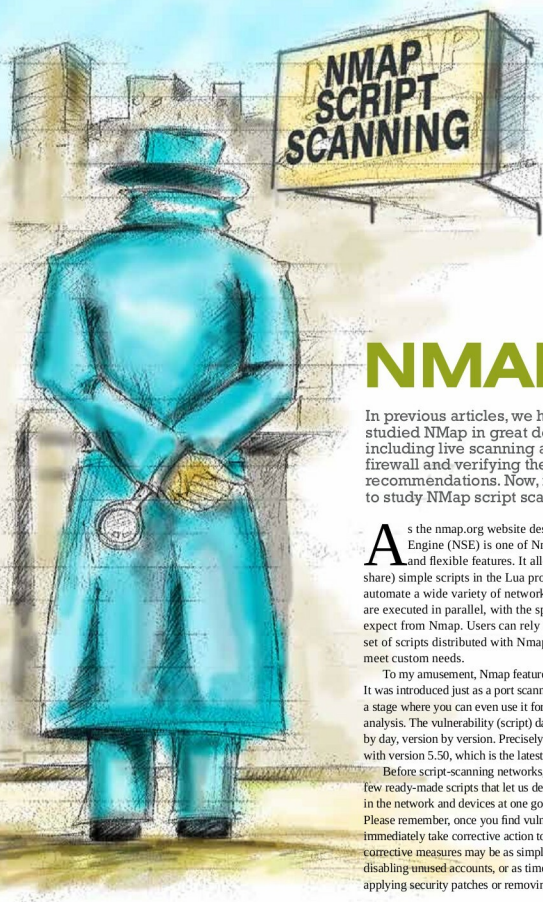




NMAP SCRIPT SCANNING

NMAP

Part—7

In previous articles, we have studied Nmap in great detail, including live scanning a firewall and verifying the recommendations. Now, it's time to study NMap script scanning.

As the nmap.org website describes, the Scripting Engine (NSE) is one of Nmap's most powerful and flexible features. It allows users to write (and share) simple scripts in the Lua programming language, to automate a wide variety of networking tasks. Those scripts are executed in parallel, with the speed and efficiency you expect from Nmap. Users can rely on the growing, diverse set of scripts distributed with Nmap, or write their own to meet custom needs.

To my amusement, Nmap features are growing day by day. It was introduced just as a port scanner, and now it has reached a stage where you can even use it for basic vulnerability analysis. The vulnerability (script) database is increasing day by day, version by version. Precisely 177 scripts are available with version 5.50, which is the latest NMap release.

Before script-scanning networks, let's try to understand a few ready-made scripts that let us detect various vulnerabilities in the network and devices at one go, in a very short time. Please remember, once you find vulnerabilities, you should immediately take corrective action to close them. These corrective measures may be as simple as changing passwords, disabling unused accounts, or as time-consuming and crucial as applying security patches or removing detected worms.